



11 Theme: sharing the planet

Themes · IB Diploma · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

Sharing the planet covers sub-topics such as the environment, climate change, human rights, peace and conflict, and global resource distribution. Receptive tasks such as listening or reading on this theme frequently present factual reports or debates, so strong comprehension responses distinguish between stated facts, statistics, and the speaker's or writer's opinion.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

Model distinction in a listening note: Fact noted, 'the river's water level dropped 30% in five years'; Opinion noted, the speaker 'believes stricter regulation is the only realistic solution', clearly separated in the candidate's notes.

Quick check · multiple choice

Which sub-topic belongs under the theme of sharing the planet?

- A Personal identity and beliefs
- B Climate change and resource distribution
- C Childhood memories
- D Workplace hierarchies

Write your choice: _____

Structured practice

Answer in the space provided.

- 1 Listening task: you will hear a short report about water shortages in a farming region (imagine the audio). Based on the description below, write the three short answers a candidate should record. [20]

Description of audio content: a reporter states that reservoir levels have dropped 40% over three years due to reduced rainfall, that local farmers have formed a cooperative to share irrigation water fairly, and that the reporter personally believes national government subsidies are needed to prevent future crises.

1. By how much have reservoir levels dropped, and over what period?
2. What solution have local farmers already put in place?
3. What is the reporter's personal opinion about a longer-term solution?

Final answer: _____



Answers and explanation

Question 1 [20]

A strong answer:

- Q1: '40% over three years', taken precisely from the audio
- Q2: 'a cooperative to share irrigation water fairly', a fact about existing local action
- Q3: clearly identifies this as the reporter's opinion, not a stated fact, 'national government subsidies are needed'
- The answer to Q3 shows the candidate has correctly separated the reporter's stated opinion from the factual details in Q1 and Q2

Quick check answer

B. Climate change and resource distribution are core sub-topics of sharing the planet, alongside human rights and peace or conflict.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or content error, then retry the practice question without looking at the solution.

Based on the IB English B guide (2018).

Original FagusED teaching material. Not an official IB publication; the sample scenarios and language are invented and generic.